

First of all, don't panic. You won't read this until it is too late to do anything.

The Alberta Government has succeeded in saving money by getting this useless person off AISH, through the only way possible to me: Death.

My Last Will and Testament is at all of these links:

<https://brucejohnson.ca/will.pdf>

[Dropbox](#), [Google Drive](#), [OneDrive](#), [Smash](#), [LimeWire](#)

I have always been ashamed of not being able to earn a living and receiving CPP Disability and AISH for the past 29 years. Throughout that time, I tried working, employment and volunteer, when I could, but couldn't do it for long. Depression, anxiety & stress. It doesn't take long for me to get to the point when I can't think straight. I am unreliable. Useless. I don't deserve to live.

Life has always been a burden to me and I've always been a burden to society and everyone around me. I am ashamed to be alive. I first tried to commit suicide 41 years ago, and I have repeatedly been unable to do so because of either survival instinct or cowardice, I don't know which. My depression started when I was about 10 years old, so has lasted 47 years. 47 years too long.

My latest volunteer work had me energized for awhile (<https://brucegraveyards.ca/>). Nobody cared about it, so I could do what I could, when I could. I almost felt good for awhile. But I kept burning out again. I got more ashamed of myself for being unable to do much. And the work doesn't matter.

Then the Alberta Government kicked me in the teeth with the introduction of ADAP.

My anxiety & stress levels sky-rocketed. My depression started to get worse and worse as time went by, as it became clear that the government wasn't backing off, that it really was going to go through with transferring almost everyone on AISH to ADAP, reduce our benefits, and expect us to find employment, or else.

Even more ashamed and depressed, I evaluated my employability. I can work maybe 2-3 in a day, but then the next day or two, I can't think, I'm useless. What work I do, I do too slowly. I make mistakes, no matter how careful I am. I can't deal with people much, I'm very negative. My university education is now useless. What skills I had, have degraded through depression, anxiety, and stress. I've tried, but am unable to revitalize my computer skills. I used to fix computers, but by the time I quit that, I couldn't fix the weird problems with my own computer. I bought a new one, and now just a little over a year later, it has things going wrong that I can't figure out how to fix, so I give up.

I started to look for work again. Something I could do remotely via computer and Internet. Surely there must be something I can do? Every job opening I look at requires someone who is outgoing, energetic, positive, and a people person, not me. I can't relocate, as I'm already living in the cheapest way possible and would never be able to handle the stress of moving again.

Realistically, no one in their right mind should give me a job.

I got the expected letter saying I am transferred to ADAP. From everything I've read about ADAP, I'm going to be **required** to participate in "employment supports" and look for work, or face losing ADAP financial support. I've already tried all that. There is no point in trying anymore.

Time to die.

Don't castigate me for **not** asking for help. In the past it was useless or caused even more problems. I grew up being bullied and "picked-on". The bigger the group, the worse it was. I was always on the defensive and couldn't trust anyone. I've never been able to make and retain friends. Then there was the massive conflict between my biology and my inability to talk to girls/women I was interested in. My need to give and receive romantic love and sex was a huge drive that was in battle against my shyness, fear, and distrust. My first date at age 19 lasted only minutes because I had a panic attack and essentially ran away so she wouldn't see me cry.

The anxiety and stress is still very high if I'm around other people. So being in the hospital with a lot of other people, most of whom are having problems too, is worse than a normal crowd of people. I **had** to be on the defense to protect myself from the others. The stress and anxiety make the experience torture. The second time I was in the hospital psych ward, I resolved that it would never happen again. I was/am better off alone.

Group therapy? Impossible. When I wasn't about to have a panic attack, I was brought to tears by what the others said. I hated myself even more for having piddly little problems compared to theirs. There was no way I was going to reveal my problems and secrets to them. The anxiety and stress of the situation was too much for me to handle.

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy? I was very disappointed when I learned what that was. It was basically what I had already been doing during the 10 years between leaving home and my first hospitalization. Force myself to be positive. Resolve that everything was going to change for the better. Tell myself good things. "Fake it until you make it". It didn't work before, and even contributed to my mental break, so why would lie to myself anymore?

Luckily I was spared ECT because of a brain tumor (a whole other story). When I learned more about ECT and saw the effect it had on other patients, I realized it wouldn't do me any good. A seizure causing confusion and some short term memory loss might help someone who has been depressed a short time, but it not going to help someone who has been suffering for decades.

Talking one-on-one? I get more and more upset as I talk about my problems, bringing them into the forefront of my mind. I would be extremely upset and suicidal for a week or more afterward such a talk.

So I went back to hiding everything I was feeling. Lying to doctors so I wouldn't be locked up again in hospital hell. Stay at home by myself, try not to think about the problems. Avoid people. Avoid women especially.

But I had a huge need to work. If I'm not working, I am not worthy of living. Someone who doesn't earn a living doesn't deserve to live on the backs of others. So I tried again and again, burning out, stressing out, making mistakes, being slow, useless. My self-worth getting beaten down repeatedly

Hell, even watching TV or reading can stress me out, and/or get me upset. But if the story is not mentally stimulating, then the stupidity of it disgusts me. The stupidity everywhere I look in the world disgusts me, but I can't do anything about it.

I'm 57 and now have diabetes, high blood pressure, glaucoma, diabetic neuropathy. Luckily the horrible migraine headaches that I suffered from, from my early memories until my mid twenties are gone. That's because the brain tumor that was caused by a head injury as a toddler, had stopped growing.

Shoulder pain that won't go away and gets worse if I do the exercises that are supposed to help. I could get x-rays and wait many months to see a specialist, but apparently the most likely treatment is to do nothing. Why waste everyone's time with all that? My age shows now in that any physical exertion results in aches and pains. I am weaker than before. Suddenly I now have trouble opening jars. Exercise only causes pain. The last time I exercised by squeezing a rubber ball, was 2 weeks ago, and while my left arm recovered, my right has not. Constant pain, because I am right handed, and even using a computer mouse keeps the pain going. I take 9 pills a day, which costs the government a lot of money. It is wasted on me.

ADAP is just something that has finally pushed me to end everything. It wasn't the proverbial "straw that broke the camel's back". It was an anvil. It catapulted me over the edge into a massive spiral of anxiety, stress, depression, self loathing, leading to death. I have to overcome my survival instinct and cowardice, don't think, just do it, and be **thorough, make sure there is no way out!** Life is untenable, a torture everyday, in which experience has taught me that nothing can help. Only oblivion. I won't say "Goodbye", because there is nothing good.

Bruce A. Johnson
531-3 st W
Empress, AB T0J 1E0